

Nisha Appanah

AI Product and Technology Leader

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SUMMARY

AI Product and Technology Leader with 20 years of experience in software engineering, product management and AI. Built and modernized platforms serving 1M+ monthly users, led cross-functional product and engineering teams of up to 17 people and delivered products across 5 countries. Founded an AI consultancy helping businesses automate processes with AI.

SELECTED IMPACT

- Built and modernized platforms serving 1M+ monthly users and 3M+ sessions per month.
- Pitched an AI Agent to executive leadership and secured approval to advance.
- Conference speaker on data privacy, AI agents and robotics.
- Led cross-functional product and engineering teams of up to 17 people.
- Founded Aplica, an AI consultancy helping businesses automate with AI.

EXPERIENCE

Founder, Aplica Ltd

Nov 2024 - Present | Mauritius

- Built an AI agent in n8n to automate responses to villa rental inquiries.
- Secured an AI consulting agreement with Cybernaptics Ltd.
- Speak at conferences on data privacy, AI agents and robotics.
- Led client discovery sessions to identify AI automation opportunities.
- Developed rapid AI prototypes using low-code development tools.

Product Manager, AI Team and Property Marketplace, Ringier South Africa

Jun 2019 - Oct 2024

- Drove the product roadmap for the largest property marketplace in 3 countries (BuyRentKenya, Imobiliare Romania, Mamaison Senegal).
- Migrated platforms serving 1M+ unique users and 3M+ sessions per month.
- Led 2 major platform migrations in Kenya and Romania.
- Scaled the team from 7 to 17 while running backlog refinement, sprint planning, daily stand-ups and retrospectives.
- Pitched an AI Agent to the C-suite and secured approval to advance.
- Validated AI demand via interviews and early sign-ups across 3 markets.

Senior Software Developer, Ringier South Africa

Feb 2017 - Jun 2019

- Architected the end-to-end property listing flow deployed across 5 countries.
- Developed a dynamic form builder powering landing pages.
- Migrated the legacy web solution to the latest .NET technology stack.

Managing Director, Aplica Ltd

Mar 2015 - Jan 2017 | Mauritius

- Built live housing systems for Copenhagen Business School and DTU.
- Optimized algorithms, memory and database usage to resolve load issues.
- Designed and developed new features based on customer requests.
- Delivered technical training sessions to Danish partners.

Project Manager, Expand Technology

Feb 2013 - Feb 2015 | Mauritius

- Managed the product backlog, weekly sprint planning and daily Scrum meetings for a team of 7.
- Coded the business logic of a smartcard payment web solution.

CEO, KnowGo Ltd

Feb 2012 - Oct 2012 | Mauritius

- Co-managed the ERP system with the other director, overseeing PAYE and NPS compliance.
- Coordinated the accountant, bank, lessor and employees on general company matters.
- Led the development team, assigning tasks and organizing Scrum meetings for a workflow product.
- Engaged existing and prospective clients in Denmark.

Project Manager, KnowGo Ltd

Jun 2010 - Jan 2012 | Mauritius

- Developed software that generates web solutions from workflow rules.
- Built design, runtime and admin web services.
- Added custom user controls such as NemID for authentication.
- Maintained infrastructure and deployments.

Software Developer, Swteams Ltd

Dec 2006 - Jul 2010

- Developed 2 university web solutions for summer courses and residences.
- Built WCF services for the PEPPOL project funded by the European Commission.
- Built an app commercialised on mailedi.dk to send business documents.
- Built rule engine modules for an internal search engine.

Programmer and Part-Time Tutor, University of Mauritius

Nov 2005 - Nov 2006

- Programmed the I-Learn platform for university students.
- Trained IC3 instructors reaching 400,000 Mauritians.
- Taught IT courses to undergraduate students.
- Lectured an IT proficiency course to university staff.

SKILLS

Product Leadership: Product roadmap ownership, product strategy, platform migrations, marketplace growth, stakeholder management, C-suite partnership, cross-market coordination, data-driven decision making, experimentation.

AI and Automation: OpenAI (ChatGPT, API), Claude, Gemini, Hugging Face, AI Studio, Lovable, Jules, Replit, n8n, Vercel, AI agents, prompt engineering, generative AI, low-code development.

Programming and Frameworks: C#, .NET Framework, ASP.NET, MVC, LINQ, WCF, XML, XSLT, HTML, CSS, VBA, Kendo UI, Telerik UI, Telerik Open Access, full-stack software development.

Development Tools: Visual Studio, Git, SVN, IIS, VMware, Amazon Web Services (AWS), Jira, Trello, SQL Server, MySQL.

Methodologies and Practices: Agile, Scrum, sprint planning, backlog management, daily stand-ups, retrospectives, team leadership, cross-functional team management.

EDUCATION

Master of International Business

Curtin University, Australia | 2014 - 2016

MSc Computer Science and Engineering

University of Technology, Mauritius | 2005 - 2007

BSc Information Technology

University of Canberra, Australia | 2002 - 2005

CERTIFICATIONS

- Google AI Professional, Google, March 2026 (Credential ID W33RRX7IQAR2)
- AI Agents Fundamentals, Hugging Face, February 2025
- Advanced Product Management: Vision, Strategy and Metrics, Udemy, August 2023
- Vibe Coding
- miniCON Agentic AI

CONFERENCE SPEAKING

- **Exploring AI Agents: From Fundamentals to Implementation** (2025). Introduced the fundamentals of AI agents using n8n, showing how they operate and demoing a production use case.
- **Navigating the AI Landscape** (2023). Shared practical experience with the OpenAI API and running large language models locally.
- **Build and Program an Interactive Robot** (2021). Demonstrated building a robot from scratch with live programming.
- **How to Program a Robot Arm** (2019). Built and programmed a 3D-printed robotic arm with a screen interface, explaining servo control for coordinated movement.

LANGUAGES

English, French, Mauritian Creole

REFERENCES

Available on request.